

Emissions per person down 44%, or off track for 2030?

A public claim, tested against EU and Eurostat data

THE CLAIM

“Emissions per capita have fallen by 44% since 2005, well above the EU average of 34%.”

Climate Action Authority, press release, 13 November 2025

Citing the European Commission's Climate Action Progress Report 2025.

The same EU report projects Malta will miss its 2030 target by the widest margin in the EU in percentage points.

VERDICT

MISLEADING

*Accurate numbers,
incomplete picture.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

–44%

The figure is right

Eurostat data reproduce the per-person fall (EU: –34%). Power-sector emissions fell 63%.

3rd / 20th

Per person vs in total

Malta's cut ranks 3rd of 27 per person, 20th in total: population grew 41%. In tonnes, –27% vs EU –33%.

+30 pts

Over the yearly limit, 2024

Target-sector emissions +41% vs a limit of +11%; over every year since 2022. A 2021 surplus has covered it so far.

49 pts

Projected 2030 gap

Even with planned measures the Commission projects +30% against –19%: the EU's largest gap in percentage points.

+49%

Transport since 2005

Buildings and air-conditioning gases rose too, in total. Per person, the target sectors are flat, not falling.

FAIR TO SAY

Cutting power-sector emissions by almost two-thirds was real. Per person, target-sector emissions are flat (2.50 t to 2.52 t, our estimate), and no compliance shortfall has arisen yet.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ The source and scope of the 44% and 34% figures.
- ☐ What “40% by 2030” covers: total or target sectors?
- ☐ A dated plan taking target-sector emissions from +41% to –19%.
- ☐ How much Malta expects to rely on buying allocations.